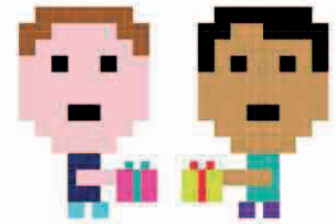


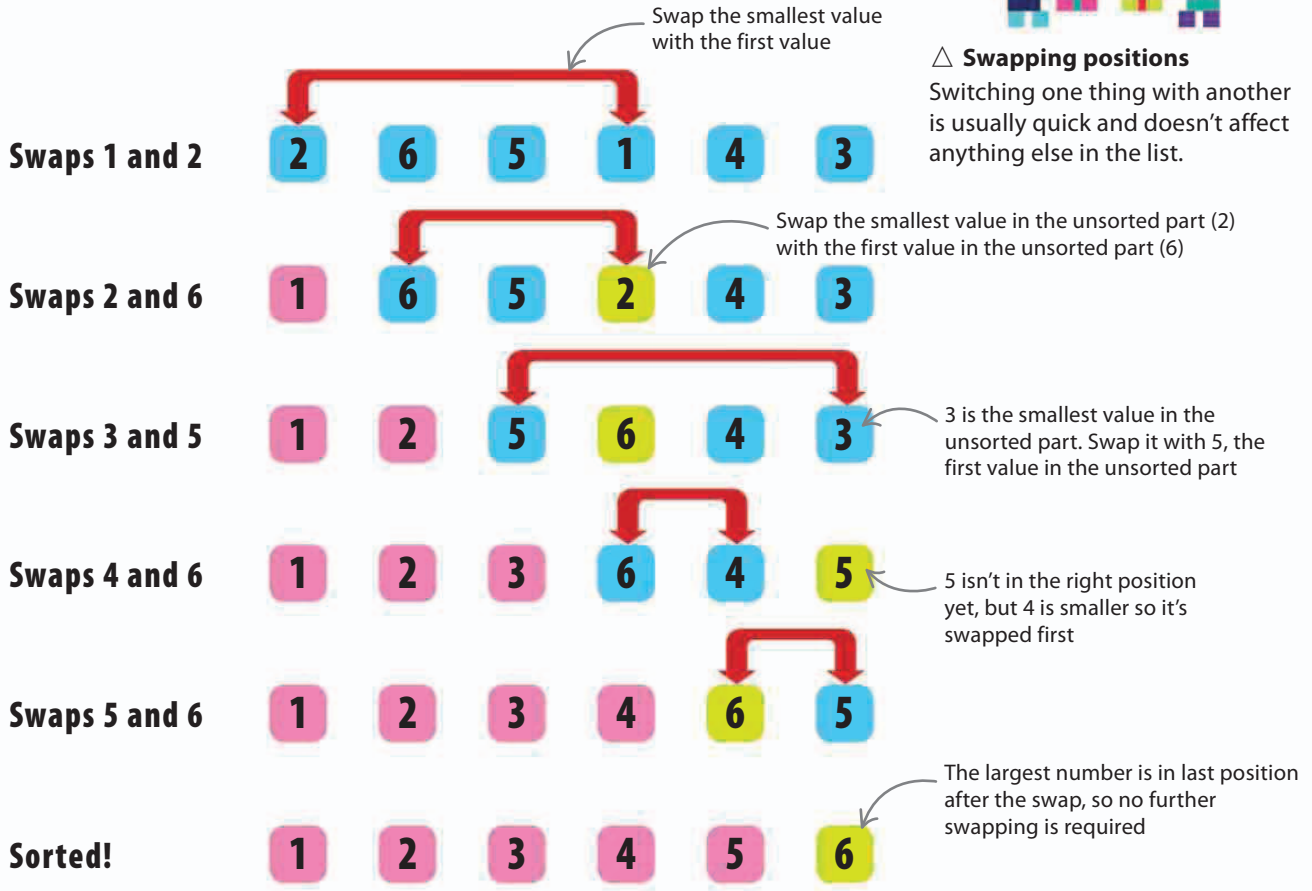
Selection sort

"Selection sort" works differently to "insertion sort". It swaps pairs of items rather than constantly shifting all of the items. Each swap moves one number to its final (sorted) position.



△ Swapping positions

Switching one thing with another is usually quick and doesn't affect anything else in the list.



EXPERT TIPS

Sorting in Python

There are lots of different sorting algorithms, each with different strengths and weaknesses. Python's "sort()" function uses an algorithm called "Timsort", named after its designer, Tim Peters. It's based on two sorting algorithms: "Insertion sort" and "Merge sort". Type in this code to see how it works.

```
>>> a = [4, 9, 3, 8, 2, 6, 1, 5, 7]
>>> a.sort()
>>> a
[1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9]
```

"a" is a list of unsorted numbers

This calls the "sort()" function

The numbers in list "a" are now sorted